only to deal with the exploitation of labour in the form of non-payment of national minimum wage.

Make the Minimum Wage Work by an Employment Guarantee Programme

The government should redesign all employment-oriented programmes by merging them into and expanding MGNREGA into a work programme to provide work on national minimum wages, fixed on the basis of the consumption expenditure requirement of a healthy person, to every person of twenty years or more on demand, to be utilized for creation of public infrastructure and provision of public goods and services to the community.

The programme would convert labour into public goods and would help both labour to get the means for sustenance and the government to get public works done using people's skill sets.

The success of the programme could be measured by the fact that there is no unemployment and no one in the workforce gets paid less than the national minimum wage.

A Comprehensive Social Security Code for Households, Not Labour

India's workers' participation rate has fallen below 40 per cent. This means 60 per cent of the population in the working age of fifteen to sixty-five does not even want to work. More than 90 per cent of the workforce works in the unorganized sector or informally. Even the 4 per cent of working-age people who work in the organized/formal sectors are witnessing the change in the employer-employee relationship and the mode of compensation. No social security code based on the concept of worker or labour is likely to provide a safety net to all households.